

Use Several Mathematical Ideas in Financial Decisions

Use numbers, calculations and reasoning to make smart financial choices.

★ Today I am learning to use several mathematical ideas in financial decisions.

Step 9

Lower Elementary
(Grades 3–4)

1. Plan a Purchase

You have \$50 to spend.
Choose items to buy.
You can buy more than one.
Do not spend more than \$50.

 Water bottle \$12	 Soccer ball \$18	 Cap \$10
 Book \$15	 Headphones \$25	 Board game \$30

My Choices		
Item	Price	Yes / No

My Calculations

Total I will spend: \$ _____

Money left over: \$ _____

2. Compare Options

You want to buy new shoes.
Compare the two options.
Which option is the better deal?
Show your thinking.

Option A



- Price: \$80
- 20% off

Option B



- Price: \$75
- \$10 cashback

My Thinking

Better deal: ☐ Option A ☐ Option B
Why? _____

3. Budget for a Week

You have \$35 to use for the week.
Plan how you will spend your money.

Item	Planned Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)
Lunches		
Snacks		
Transport		
Fun / Activities		
Other		
Total		

Think and Answer

a) Did you go over or under your budget?

- ☐ Over
☐ Under
☐ On budget

b) How much money was left at the end of the week?
\$ _____



4. Savings Goal

You want to buy a tablet that costs \$240.
You already have \$60 saved.
How much more do you need to save?
Complete the table to find out.



Save Each Week (\$)	Number of Weeks	Total You Will Save (\$)	Total With \$60 Saved (\$)	Goal Reached?
\$10	_____	_____	_____	☐ Yes / No
\$15	_____	_____	_____	☐ Yes / No
\$20	_____	_____	_____	☐ Yes / No
\$30	_____	_____	_____	☐ Yes / No

Which plan will reach your goal the fastest? _____
How do you know? _____

5. Make a Smart Choice

Read each situation. Use numbers and reasons to decide what is the smartest choice.

a) Coffee shop

Small coffee: \$4.50
Large coffee: \$6.00
You are buying 5 coffees.
Which is better value?
Show your working.



b) Movie night

Option 1: Rent a movie for \$6.00
Option 2: Pay \$15.00 for unlimited movies this month
You will watch 4 movies.
Which option is better?
Why?



c) Supermarket

Apples
• 6 for \$3.00
• 10 for \$4.50
Which pack is better value?
Show your working.



d) Phone plan

Plan A: \$25 per month
Plan B: \$18 per month + \$0.15 per minute call
You talk for 80 minutes in a month.
Which plan is cheaper?
Show your working.



6. Real-Life Problem Solving

You want to go on a day trip with your family.
The total cost is \$180.
Your family of 4 can share the cost equally.
You have already paid \$40.



- a) How much more money do you need to pay in total?
\$ _____
- b) How much will each person pay in the end?
\$ _____

My Learning Check

Circle how confident you feel.



I used...



Today I learned...

One thing I did well: _____

One thing I will improve: _____